Carlos César Chávez Padilla

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Development economist combining structural estimation with high-frequency data. Research Professional with James J. Heckman (U. of Chicago); builder of Qhawarina, a real-time open-data platform for Peru.

Education

University of Chicago, M.A. in Public Policy (Harris School) 2024–2025
Universidad Nacional Mayor de San Marcos, B.A. Economics 2013–2017
Universidad Nacional de Ingeniería, Diplomas in Applied Econometrics & Finance 2018

Experience

Research Professional, Center for the Economics of Human Development, U. of Chicago 2025–present

- Work with Prof. James J. Heckman on early-childhood skill formation and economic preferences; structural model (accepted, *Journal of Labor Economics*).
- Build estimation and data pipelines in Stata, R, and Python; present results to academic and policy audiences.

Research Analyst / Assistant, International Monetary Fund (MCM Department) 2020–2023

- Co-authored IMF Working Paper on ethnic gaps and growth in Peru; built cross-country panels on political instability and macro outcomes (180+ countries).
- Supported country missions to Sweden, South Africa, and Caribbean nations.

Research Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank 2019–2020
Pre-Doctoral Fellow, Georgetown University (McDonough) — ML/NLP on U.S. legislative records 2023–2024

Independent Project

Qhawarina — real-time open-data platform tracking 42,000+ products and daily economic indicators across Peru's 25 regions; nowcasts of GDP and inflation built from web-scraped prices. cesarchavezp29.github.io/projects/qhawarina

Selected Research

- Relating Cognitive Skills and Personality Traits to Economic Preferences (with Feng, Heckman, Yang) — *accepted, Journal of Labor Economics.*
- Commodity Booms and Violent Conflict — *under review, American Journal of Political Science.*
- Peer-reviewed work in *Mineral Economics*, *Journal of Economics, Race & Policy*, *Review of Economics*, *Foreign Trade Review.*

Skills

Programming: Stata, R (advanced); Python, Matlab (proficient). **Methods:** structural estimation, panel econometrics, causal inference, IV, machine learning, NLP. **Languages:** Spanish (native), English (fluent).